

Artur Back de Luca

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ABOUT ME

My current work focuses on understanding and improving the reasoning capabilities of neural networks. More specifically, I study how they can learn to perform tasks for which efficient classical algorithms already exist, and how correct solutions can emerge through training. Understanding these characteristics is crucial for designing models that exhibit a more consistent behavior. In addition to this, I spent more than two years applying machine learning to real-world applications.

EDUCATION

University of Waterloo, Waterloo, Ontario, Canada

Doctor of Philosophy in Computer Science.

Sep 2022 – May 2027 (expected)

Supervisor: Kimon Fountoulakis, Associate Professor

Sapienza University of Rome, Rome, Lazio, Italy

M.Sc. in Artificial Intelligence and Robotics.

Sep 2019 – Jul 2022

Universidade Federal de Santa Catarina, Florianopolis, Santa Catarina, Brazil

B.Sc. in Mechanical Engineering.

Aug 2013 – Feb 2019

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Applied Science Intern – **Amazon**, Supply Chain Optimization Technologies (SCOT)

New York, United States

Jun 2025 – Sep 2025

Developed scalable probabilistic forecasting models for sparse, nested time series that reduced manual feature engineering and improved inbound quantity prediction accuracy.

Support Research Intern – **Huawei Canada**, Noah's Ark Lab

Toronto, Canada

Feb 2022 – Jan 2023

Researched Federated Learning techniques to enhance model generalization while preserving data privacy, focusing on domain-generalization techniques.

Research Consultant – **CERTI Foundation** and Micromed

Florianopolis, Brazil

Feb 2021 – Jan 2022

Developed a machine learning system to detect QT intervals in ECGs using spectral analyses and fine-tuned ResNet models. Integrated the solution into a diagnostic platform for Long QT Syndrome.

LIST OF PUBLICATIONS

Conference Proceedings

A. Back de Luca, G. Giapitzakis, and K. Fountoulakis. Learning to Add, Multiply, and Execute Algorithmic Instructions Exactly with Neural Networks. In: *Annual Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems* (NeurIPS 2025).

A. Back de Luca, G. Giapitzakis, S. Yang, P. Veličković, K. Fountoulakis. Positional Attention: Expressivity and Learnability of Algorithmic Computation. In: *International Conference on Machine Learning* (ICML 2025).

A. Back de Luca, K. Fountoulakis. Simulation of Graph Algorithms with Looped Transformers. In: *International Conference on Machine Learning* (ICML 2024).

A. Back de Luca, K. Fountoulakis, S. Yang. Local Graph Clustering with Noisy Labels. In: *International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR 2024)*.

Workshop papers

M. Qharabagh, **A. Back de Luca**, G. Giapitzakis and K. Fountoulakis. Learning to Execute Graph Algorithms Exactly with Graph Neural Networks. In Workshop on Latent & Implicit Thinking at ICLR 2026.

G. Giapitzakis, **A. Back de Luca** and K. Fountoulakis. Exact Learning of Permutations for Nonzero Binary Inputs with Logarithmic Training Size and Quadratic Ensemble Complexity. In: High-dimensional Learning Dynamics Workshop at ICML 2025.

Preprints

A. Back de Luca, G. Zhang, X. Chen, Y. Yu. Mitigating Data Heterogeneity in Federated Learning with Data Augmentation. 2022.

AWARDS

Canada Graduate Research Scholarship (CGRS D) \$40,000 offered by NSERC.	2026–2027.
President’s Graduate Scholarship (PGS) \$10,000 offered by the University of Waterloo.	2026–2027.
Graduate Scholarship in Data & AI \$15,000 offered by TD and Layer 6.	2025–2026.
David R. Cheriton Graduate Scholarship \$10,000 offered by the University of Waterloo.	2025–2026.
Ontario Graduate Scholarship (OGS) \$15,000 offered by the Ontario government.	2025–2026.
President’s Graduate Scholarship (PGS) \$5,000 offered by the University of Waterloo.	2025–2026.
Math Domestic Graduate Award. \$4,000 offered by University of Waterloo.	2023-2024.
International Master’s Award of Excellence. \$7,500 offered by University of Waterloo.	2022-2023.

TEACHING ACTIVITIES

University of Waterloo, Teaching Assistant.

Responsibilities include supporting undergraduate course activities, grading assignments and exams, and holding office hours.

CS 338 – Computer Applications in Business: Databases	Winter 2026
CS 235 – Data Types and Structures	Fall 2025
CS 479/679 – Neural Networks	Winter 2025
CS 348 – Introduction to Database Systems	Fall 2024
CS 475/675 – Computational Linear Algebra	Spring 2024
CS 338 – Computer Applications in Business: Databases	Winter 2024
CS 245 – Logic and Computation	Fall 2022, Spring 2023, Fall 2023

OTHER PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Engineering Intern – NEO Empresarial.	2015 – 2018
Data Analytics Intern – CERTI Foundation.	Summers 2017 and 2018
Research Intern – Fraunhofer Institute for Production Technology.	2017 – 2018
Procurement Intern – Whirlpool/ Embraco.	Summer 2016
Research Intern – SINMEC Lab.	Spring 2015